

505 Sports Media Marketing Team (Pilot)

(new event)

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will create and present a Sports Media Marketing Campaign for a real or hypothetical sports organization, event, or athlete. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this judged team event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. Teams must be registered for the national competition before the submission deadline and compete in both parts of the event to be ranked. Entries that do not follow the provided topic, or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic - NextGen Athlete – Building the Brand of a Rising Sports Star

NextGen Athlete is a fictitious sports marketing agency representing a talented young professional athlete who recently gained national attention following a breakout season. While the athlete's on-field performance has generated excitement among fans, their personal brand and media presence are still developing.

The agency believes there is an opportunity to build a recognizable and marketable athlete brand through a strategic sports media marketing campaign that leverages social media platforms, digital storytelling, and partnerships with sponsors and influencers. A strong personal brand can help increase fan engagement, expand the athlete's audience, and attract endorsement opportunities. The athlete's current fan base primarily consists of younger sports fans who actively follow athletes through platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, and other digital media channels. However, the athlete faces competition from many other rising athletes who are also building their presence across sports media platforms.

Your consulting firm has been hired to develop a sports media marketing campaign designed to strengthen the athlete's personal brand and increase fan engagement. Your campaign should demonstrate how sports media marketing strategies can build brand loyalty, expand the athlete's audience, and create opportunities for partnerships and sponsorships. Teams should analyze the target audience, evaluate the competitive sports media landscape, and design an integrated marketing campaign that leverages digital media, social platforms, and emerging technologies. Teams may make reasonable assumptions where data is not provided; however, assumptions should be reasonable, clearly explained, and supported by research where possible. Teams must develop their campaign based on the NextGen Athlete concept described in this case study and may create a fictional athlete profile consistent with the NextGen Athlete scenario. Campaigns proposing unrelated organizations or athletes will not be evaluated.

Teams should consider elements such as:

- target audience demographics and fan engagement behavior
- athlete brand identity and positioning
- social media marketing strategies and content creation
- influencer collaborations and partnerships
- sponsorship and endorsement opportunities
- integrated digital media promotion
- creative campaign elements such as short-form video or teaser content
- long-term brand growth and fan loyalty

Team Must Supply

- For each round of presentations (preliminaries and finals) contestants may share supporting materials (e.g., research charts, brochures, etc.). These materials may be used during the presentation but must not be left with the judges.
- Students may use one single-sided laptop, notebook, or tablet for their presentation. Projection equipment and external displays will not be provided or permitted.
- Optional - Visuals such as social media mockups, digital advertisements, campaign graphics, etc.

Contest Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- Only one (1) team member should complete the submission
- The team captain's contestant ID should be used in any required documents
- Contestants will present their Sports Media Marketing Campaign as if pitching to an athlete management team, sports organization, or potential sponsor. Teams may incorporate the campaign teaser video or other visual materials as part of the presentation.
- Carry-in and setup of equipment must be done solely by the team within the time allotted
- No Internet access will be provided on-site at NLC; however, teams may provide their own access to be used only for their presentation to the judges
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes setup, no more than ten (10) minutes oral presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes judges' questions
- Finals may be part of the competition
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Naming Convention	National Deadline
Submit all the following in one combined PDF: 1. URL to Video Teaser 2. Sports Media Marketing Campaign, including the Title Page, Table of Contents 3. Works Cited 4. BPA Release Form(s) 5. AI Usage and Documentation Form	SMMT-TeamID.pdf	April 1, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Develop and justify a sports media marketing strategy that applies to the marketing mix and demonstrates the role of branding and brand loyalty within the global sports industry
2. Analyze sports audiences and consumer behavior by using demographic, psychographic, and fan engagement data to inform marketing decisions and buying influences
3. Design integrated marketing communications for sports organizations or events by leveraging digital media, social platforms, and emerging technologies such as influencer marketing
4. Evaluate ethical, legal, and technological considerations affecting sports media marketing, including sponsorship transparency, data use, and platform selection
5. Create innovative and creative marketing content that demonstrates originality, strategic thinking, and adaptability to current sports media trends
6. Apply critical thinking and problem-solving skills to address marketing challenges and optimize campaign outcomes
7. Demonstrate professional communication and presentation skills by delivering clear, persuasive, and informative pitches using digital and visual media
8. Collaborate effectively as a team in a marketing environment to plan, produce, and present a cohesive campaign within a global and diverse context

Contest Specifications for this Event

Sports Media Marketing Campaign:

- The Sports Media Marketing Campaign, including the Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited must be formatted according to the Title Page, Table of Contents, Social Media Marketing Campaign (Parts I-VII), and Works Cited guidelines in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- The Sports Media Marketing Campaign (Parts I-VII) must not exceed five (5) pages single-sided. The Title Page, Table of Contents, Works Cited, and BPA Release Forms are not included in the five (5) page limit
- Any Sports Media Marketing Campaigns submitted beyond the maximum number of five (5) pages will be disqualified.

Campaign Teaser Video:

- Teams must create one promotional teaser video representing the campaign concept
- The video must be created by the student team specifically for this event and represent original campaign content. The use of broadcast sports footage, copyrighted highlight clips, or professional game footage is not permitted unless it is legally licensed and properly cited.
- The teaser video must:
 - be 15–30 seconds in length and represent the launch promotion for the campaign
 - align with the campaign strategy described in the written campaign
 - be suitable for distribution on short-form digital platforms such as Instagram Reels, TikTok, or YouTube Shorts
- The teaser video should demonstrate the team's ability to create engaging sports media marketing content designed to generate fan interest, audience engagement, and brand awareness.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- This is a pre-submitted event. Regional and state conferences have specific deadlines prior to the national deadlines. Please consult the regional or state conference administrator for those deadlines. For the National Leadership Conference, submit project files at <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on April 1, 2027.
- Upload completed projects along with the video teaser to a video/file sharing link (Vimeo, YouTube, Dropbox, etc.). Projects must be viewable on Windows and Mac platforms. Set the access level of your project to one of BPA's recommended settings. See the Cloud Sharing Guidelines for additional information.
- The team is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will not be returned and will not be available at NLC.

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Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.	☐ Y ☐ N			
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence & Citation Policy.	☐ Y ☐ N			
The teaser video did not exceed the 30 second limit and the Sports Media Marketing plan did not exceed five (5) pages single-sided. The Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited are not included in the five (5) page limit.	☐ Y ☐ N			
If answered no to any question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the disqualification:				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing a URL to the teaser video, the Sports Media Marketing Plan Campaign, including the Title Page, Table of Contents, Works Cited formatted according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> , BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form.				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations (0-10)	Meets Expectations (11-20)	Above Expectations (21-30)	Points Awarded
Brand Identity and Positioning	Brand identity is vague, inconsistent, or weakly connected to the sports context.	Brand identity is clear and generally appropriate for the sports context.	Brand identity is distinctive, cohesive, and strategically positioned	/30
Target Audience Analysis	Target audience is broad, unclear, or weakly supported by data.	Target audience is clear and supported by relevant audience information.	Target audience is precise, research-supported, and clearly informs campaign decisions.	/30
Competitive Sports Media Landscape	Competitive analysis is limited, generic, or weakly connected to strategy.	Competitive landscape is adequately analyzed and connected to campaign decisions.	Competitive analysis is thorough, relevant, and used strategically.	/30
Sports Media Marketing Strategy	Strategy is unclear, underdeveloped, or too general.	Strategy is clear, appropriate, and generally supported.	Strategy is comprehensive, well-justified, and strongly aligned to the assigned case.	/30
Content Strategy	Content strategy is incomplete, generic, or poorly aligned to the sports context.	Content strategy includes relevant tactics and generally supports campaign goals.	Content strategy is original, integrated, platform-appropriate, and engagement-focused.	/30
Partnership and Sponsorship Opportunities	Partnership or sponsorship ideas are vague, unrealistic, or poorly matched.	Partnership and sponsorship ideas are reasonable and generally aligned.	Partnership and sponsorship ideas are strategic, realistic, and brand aligned.	/30
Campaign Measurement and Growth	Measures are vague, unrealistic, or disconnected from campaign goals.	Measures are clear and reasonably connected to campaign goals.	Measures are specific, actionable, and support growth and optimization.	/30

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Technical Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations (0-13)	Meets Expectations (14-27)	Above Expectations (28-40)	Points Awarded
Campaign Teaser Video	Video is missing, noncompliant, off-strategy, or ineffective.	Video is student-created, compliant, aligned, and appropriate for short-form platforms.	Video is original, polished, strategic, and highly effective for engagement.	/40
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations (0-9)	Meets Expectations (10-15)	Above Expectations (16-20)	Points Awarded
Overall Appearance, Conciseness, and Completeness	Campaign is disorganized, wordy, or missing sections.	Campaign is organized, concise, and complete.	Campaign is polished, professional, concise, and complete.	/20
Grammar and Mechanics	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/300

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Team rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence, team roles, transitions, visuals, supporting materials, and/or teaser video are unclear or poorly integrated.	Presentation is generally organized; team roles are clear, transitions are adequate, and visuals, supporting materials, and/or teaser video are appropriately integrated.	Presentation flows smoothly; team roles, transitions, visuals, supporting materials, and/or teaser video are polished and strategically integrated.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-15 points	Meets Expectations 16-30 points	Above Expectations 31-45 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the campaign, assigned sports context, audience, platforms, partnerships, measurement or teaser video purpose.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the campaign, assigned sports context, audience, platforms, partnerships, measurement and teaser video connection.	Presentation demonstrates a strong understanding of the campaign, assigned sports context, audience, platforms, partnerships, measurement and teaser's video role in engagement.	/45
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes including 15-30 second teaser video.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES